

December 1, 2025

CITY OF CONWAY
CITY COUNCIL MEETING
CONWAY CITY HALL
229 MAIN STREET, CONWAY
MONDAY, DECEMBER 1, 2025

PRESENT: Mayor Barbara Jo Blain, Mayor Pro Tem William Goldfinch, Amanda Butler, Julie Hardwick, Beth Helms, Justin Jordan and Larry White.

STAFF: Adam Emrick, City Administrator; Mary Catherine Hyman, Deputy City Administrator; John Rogers, Deputy City Administrator; June Wood, Public Information Officer; Jeff Leveille, Technology Services Director; Jason Perzan, Deputy Fire Chief; Reggie Jenerette, Solid Waste Director; Robert Cooper, Construction Services Director; Lynn Smith, Human Resource Director; Ted Dudley, Public Utilities Director; Jessica Hucks, Planning and Development Director; Brandon Harrelson, Public Works Director; Dale Long, Police Chief; Timmy Williams, Hospitality and Beautification Director; Kayla Fleming, Municipal Judge; Ashley Smith, Recreation Director; Kelly Thomas, Deputy PIO; David Crotts, Procurement and Inventory Division Chief; Katie Dennis, Planner; and Alicia Shelley, City Clerk.

OTHERS: There were approximately 25 others in attendance.

CALL TO ORDER: Mayor Blain called the meeting to order.

INVOCATION/PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE: Goldfinch gave the invocation and led the Pledge of Allegiance.

The requirements for posting notice of this meeting under South Carolina's Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) were met.

CONSENT AGENDA:

- A. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2025-12-01 (A) to annex approximately 0.39 acres of property located at 4 Clemson Road (PIN 383-15-02-0010).**
- B. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2025-12-01 (C) to rezone approximately 0.39+/- acres of property located at 4 Clemson Road (PIN 383-15-02-0010), from the Horry County Residential, no mobile homes allowed (SF-10) district to the City of Conway Low/ Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district upon annexation.**
- C. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2025-12-01 (D) to rezone approximately 0.35+/- acres of property located at 1328 Cottage Lane and 1636 Church Street (PINs 338-10-02-0009 & 338-10-02-0008), from the City of Conway Low/ Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district to the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district.**

December 1, 2025

- D. Final Reading of Ordinance #2025-12-01 (E) amending the Business License Ordinance of the City of Conway to update the Class Schedule as required by Act 176 of 2020.**
- E. Approval of a Resolution to accept the dedication of roadways & drainage and the financial guarantee for the roadway warranty for the Westwood Reserve, Phase 1A subdivision (Jollie Drive; Collins Farm Way; Westwood Drive; Bridgeview Drive; Kings Town Way).**
- F. Approval of November 17, 2025 Council Meeting Minutes**

APPROVAL OF CONSENT AGENDA: Motion: Butler made a motion, seconded by Hardwick to approve the December 1, 2025 consent agenda. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

SPECIAL PRESENTATION:

- A. Recognition of 2025 Artist of the City of Conway Christmas Card Contest** – Blain recognized Fernanda Loreda Martinez as the City of Conway Christmas card contest winner.
- B. Recognition of 2024 CP Quattlebaum Design Award Recipients** – Blain presented the following Quattlebaum Awards:
 - Mercy Baptist Church – Outstanding Restoration of a Non-residential Building (absent)
 - 1215 Grede Court – Outstanding New Construction of a Residential Building (absent)
 - 1109 Whopping Crane, Phill McNelis and Julie Blais – Outstanding New Construction of a Residential Building
 - Palmetto Taps, Brian Von – Outstanding Signage Project
 - Diamond Shores LLC, Collins Walk Subdivision – Outstanding Signage Project (absent)
 - SOS Health Care – Outstanding contribution to quality development, restoration, landscape or design by an organization or individual
- C. Presentation of Employee of the Month for December 2025 – Public Safety** – Perzan presented Sandy Martin, Executive Assistant of Fire Department with the Employee of the Month award.
- D. Presentation of Longevity Awards – November 2025 – 5 Years – Covell Moore, Recreation; 5 Years - Charlie Mathews, Public Utilities; 10 Years – Glenn “David” Crofts Jr., Finance; 20 Years – Christopher Weatherford, Public Utilities; 20 Years – Jamie Elliott, Public Utilities; 25 Years – Timothy Williams, Hospitality & Beautification** – Emrick and Hardwick presented the longevity awards.
- E. Discussion of a request to rezone approximately 0.44+/- acres of property located along Hwy 701 N. / N. Main Street (PIN 325-13-01-0013), from the City of Conway**

Low/ Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district to the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district. Hucks stated that this property is currently zoned R-1 and the applicant is seeking to rezone the property for future potential development under the HC district. The city's future land use map identifies the property as HC, which is a zoning intended to accommodate auto-dependent commercial development. The HC district is typically located along major arterial and highway corridors where auto-dependent development can occur, while also promoting orderly growth, coordinated access, and functional corridor aesthetics, such as those that are listed in the City's Gateway Corridor Overlay, which this property will be subject to if developed commercially. Property on either side of this property is zoned HC. Property across from it is zoned Horry County Heavy Industrial. Property located behind the subject property is the Ivy Glen development, which is zoned R-1. Hucks said that Planning Commission will hold a public hearing on the request at their December 11 meeting and their recommendation will be forwarded with first reading of the ordinance to rezone the subject property.

Hucks explained the buffer requirements in the HC district abutting the Ivy Glen development.

SECOND READING:

Second Reading of Ordinance #2024-11-18 providing for the establishment of the Riverfront Downtown Redevelopment Project Area, the approval of the Riverfront and Downtown Redevelopment Plan, and financing of redevelopment projects, and other matters related thereto. Rogers stated that this is second reading for the Riverfront Downtown Redevelopment Project area and introduced Attorney Gary Pope. Pope gave a brief overview on the consideration of second reading of the TIF plan stating that it encompasses 449 acres and 296 parcels of property. The boundaries of the Redevelopment Area include and encompass a significant portion of the city's downtown commercial area and riverfront, particularly including certain area around First, Second, Third, Fourth, and Fifth Avenues between Kingston Lake and the Waccamaw River on the north and Highway 501 on the South, and also including the former Santee Cooper property between First Avenue, Highway 501, and the Waccamaw River. Pope said that the cost of the Redevelopment Project is estimated at \$78,900,000. Second Reading allows the city to set the tax value as of December 31 of last year and that gives a base line of future investment to count towards the increment. The school district and Horry County have reserved their rights to participate and are currently planning to negotiate over the course of the coming months. Pope said that this sets the baseline value for the district to allow the city to move forward with the downtown redevelopment plan and also gives a basis to negotiate with the county and school district.

There was some discussion regarding the notice to the property owners within the plan, and the process of adding properties to the plan.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Blain to approve second reading of Ordinance #2024-11-18 . **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

FIRST READING:

- A. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-02-02 (A) to annex approximately 0.22+/- acres of property located at 250 Chevy Chase Drive (PIN 367-13-01-0031).** Hucks stated that this is a request to annex the subject property, which is being requested in accordance with city requirements for connection to city utilities. The property was transferred into the current owner's name in October, and restrictive covenants were recorded on November 10. One property directly beside the parcel is already within the city limits, which was annexed in 2011 and zoned R-1. Property directly across from the parcel is also within the city limits, zoned FA although currently undeveloped. With the exception of the undeveloped parcel and the elementary school, this area is primarily residential in nature. Nearby surrounding properties, although not contiguous, were annexed in 2016, 2017, 2020, 2023, and in June of this year; all of which are zoned R-1.

Hucks said that if first reading of the ordinance to annex is approved, Planning Commission will hold a public hearing on the requested zoning at their meeting in January 2026 and that staff does recommend first reading to annex the subject property.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Jordan to approve first reading of Ordinance #2026-02-02 (A) annexing the property at 250 Chevy Chase Drive. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- B. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-02-02 (B) to annex approximately 18.26+/- acres of property located at 1071 & 1059 Academy Drive (PIN 382-00-00-0009).** Hucks stated that council discussed this property and the potential for annexation at a council workshop a couple of months ago, where the applicant had approved plans and permit for rectory home for St. James Catholic Church, ready for pickup at Horry County Code Enforcement. When attempting to pay their water tap fees, the applicant was informed of the requirement to request annexation. The consensus of council at the workshop was that annexation would not be appropriate at this time, due to the fact that the only property on Academy Drive that would need city services, aside from city water, would be this property. However, that application is still required to request annexation. Restrictive covenants were recorded for the property on November 20, 2025.

Hucks said that staff recommended against annexation of the property at this time.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Butler to deny first reading of Ordinance #2026-02-02 (B) annexing the property at 1071 & 1059 Academy Drive. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

CONSIDERATION:

Consideration of City Assistance to Blackwater Market for Restroom Cleaning and Stocking (October – December) – Emrick said that this was a request from Russell Fowler of Blackwater Market to designate its on-site restrooms as public restrooms during the peak visitation months of October through December. They have requested that the city consider assisting with daily

December 1, 2025

cleaning and the stocking of restroom supplies during this period. Emrick said it would require an MOU, there are pros and cons, but it is an atypical situation.

There was discussion concerning how often the city's public restrooms are cleaned, the need to bring in porta potties, the labeling of the restrooms as public, liability concerns, overuse issues that may fall back on the city, MOU as a test run for December 2025, the city completely taking over ownership, responsibility of repairs when needed, and the cleaning schedule.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Goldfinch authorizing the administrator to enter into a 1-month MOU with the owners of the Black Water Market for help with the daily cleaning and stocking of their restroom for public use and then come back to council for further assistance.

Vote: Blain, Goldfinch, Jordan, White, Butler, Helms voted yes. Hardwick voted no. Motion carried 6-1.

PUBLIC INPUT:

- Lizzy Marlowe – spoke to council regarding the buffer behind her home at the dentist office saying that it encroaches on her property and, she said that she was attacked by a satanic decoration while entering city hall.

CITY ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT:

Emrick informed Council of the following:

- The city's Technology Services Department is testing out some new hardware for the Christmas season. They are installing a parking lot sensor at the Town Green parking to be able to monitor the amount of vehicles in and out of the parking lot and determine the available parking spaces in the lot. This can then be made available to the public via a dashboard. If it works well for Christmas, staff can add more parking lots in the future.
- IT is also working at adding a real time people counter to existing infrastructure. This will allow us to know, in real time, the number of people in certain areas of the City at any given moment. We will continue to use the other service that we subscribe to for the next year, and compare the data we have from the two sources.
- On Wednesday, at 1 pm, the Police Department is hosting a drop-in to celebrate the retirement of Sgt. Michelle Johnson, at the Public Safety Building.
- The Christmas Tree Lighting is this Thursday at 6 pm. Make travel plans now to avoid the traffic congestion. Main Street will close early, around 3 p.m. 3rd Avenue will close earlier than that to all for the set up to begin.
- The Tree Lighting marks the beginning of Christmas in Conway, so after the lighting of the tree, the expanded Celebration of Lights, the Christmas Carnival, and Santa's Village all begin.
- On Friday nights from now until Christmas, Horry Georgetown Technical College is sponsoring movie nights at the Terrace. This Friday, the Mayor's Youth Council will lead the event, showing a double feature of the Grinch who Stole Christmas, the 2000 version,

December 1, 2025

followed by the original 1968 version. They are also leading a Toys for Tots drive at the movie night, so bring a toy with you.

- The Reindeer Run is this Saturday beginning at the Conway Marina.
- Arbor Day celebration is this Saturday from 11am-3 pm in the Terrace. This year's Arbor Day will be a larger event than usual as we commemorate the 40th year of Conway being a Tree City USA city.
- The Holiday Market is at the Sports and Fitness Center this Saturday beginning at 9 am.
- A Christmas to Remember, where our Police and Fire Department take kids who may otherwise not have a Christmas, shopping, is this Saturday at noon. This year they are meeting at the Town Green to kick off the day.
- The 8th Annual Rivertown Regatta, Christmas Boat Parade is Saturday at dusk.
- The Under the Lights 5k is the 10th at 6 pm beginning at the Marina.
- The Sensory Friendly Christmas Tree Lighting is on the 11th at 6 pm at Riverfront Park. This is an opportunity for those who are neurodivergent or those who are uncomfortable with the large crowds that our Tree Lighting event normally brings, to have a little more relaxed and accepting event.
- The Hospitality and Beautification Department is hosting a drop in to celebrate the career of Anthony Huggins on the 12th from 11am – 2 pm. Anthony is retiring after 24 years of service to the City of Conway.
- The Christmas Parade is on the 13th. Make sure you are at the starting point of the parade no later than 9:45 am.
- Gave a shout out to our Parks and Recreation Department. Patsy Baker was featured in the National Parks and Recreation Magazine in the December 2025 issue for implementing new training techniques into her role with the City.
- There are no workshops or Executive Sessions tonight, but a short report from Jessica Hucks in the Planning Department.

Goldfinch wants the city to be the leader and encourage local cities and counties to have requirements in place where new neighborhoods have development agreements with enhancement fees to subsidize the expense of growth. Goldfinch wants to reignite the discussion, get more aggressive and go to the state with all concerns.

Emrick discussed the COLA in this area, removal of the income tax in South Carolina, growth in Horry County, traffic congestion in downtown Conway, infrastructure improvements, construction of bridges, development agreements with enhancement fees, and impact fees.

White encouraged the city to communicate with the other entities. Blain said there are many opportunities to do that with the League of Cities being one.

Hucks gave a yearly update on the Planning and Development Department.

December 1, 2025

COUNCIL INPUT:

Hardwick

- Reflected on 2025 saying it was great.
- Wished everyone a Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year.
- Said that she is looking forward to 2026 being better and brighter.
- Thanked staff for everything.

Jordan

- Said that he was looking forward to the December events.
- Wished everyone a Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year.

Goldfinch

- Wished everyone a Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year.

White

- Announced that Singleton Grocery is closing December 2025.
- Told of a tiny home community on Highway 701 and wants staff to look at getting some built in the City of Conway.
- Suggested that the Mayor's Youth Council possibly attend the National League of Cities meeting.
- Thanked Debbie for making arrangements to get him and the Mayor back to Conway.
- Wished all a Merry Christmas.

Butler

- Thanked staff for their hard work and for the amazing job on all decorations.
- Encouraged all to support Conway High School and the winter sports.
- Wished everyone a Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year.

Helms

- Announced that Conway was selected as the host city for the 2026 South Carolina State Special Olympics to be held at the Billy Gardner Sports Complex.
- Said that staff is great and she appreciates all.
- Wished everyone a Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year.
- Encouraged everyone to look out for others - Smile – Wave - Pray – Speak to people.

Blain

- Appreciates staff for all that they do.
- Said that she wants everyone to have a peaceful, safe and a loving Christmas – be kind.
- Said that people tell her how welcoming Conway is.

WORKSHOP: None

ADJOURNMENT: Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms, to adjourn the meeting.

Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

December 1, 2025

APPROVAL OF MINUTES: Minutes approved by City Council this 5 day of
January, 2026.

Alicia Shelley
Alicia Shelley, City Clerk